

WELLS FARGO (PLACEMENTS)

Role: Program Associate

Batch: 2020 – 2024

Mode: Offline

Number of Rounds: 4

About the Company:

Wells Fargo is a prominent multinational financial services company based in San Francisco, USA. They offer a wide range of services including banking, investments, credit cards, mortgages, as well as consumer and commercial finance. In India, they have offices in Chennai, Hyderabad, and Bangalore.

Round 1: Online Assessment

The online test was conducted on the SHL AMCAT platform and consisted of three sections:

1. **Verbal Aptitude**
2. **Business Aptitude**
3. **Coding Section**

This format is typical for Wells Fargo's online assessments. The verbal aptitude section tested vocabulary and comprehension. The business aptitude section focused on data interpretation from pie charts, bar charts, graphs, and stocks & exchanges. While these sections weren't particularly difficult, the time constraints made quick reading and analysis essential.

The coding section featured three problems. The first two were quite easy, and most candidates could pass all test cases. The third problem was of medium difficulty, but the challenge was compounded by the use of an older C++ version, which didn't support vectors. It was a graph-based problem with only two test cases. My code passed one of them, which turned out to be sufficient.

Out of all candidates, 59 were selected for the next round, with 22 being added just an hour before the interviews through an additional shortlist.

Tip:

The aptitude section seemed to carry more weight than the coding part. I recommend starting to practice aptitude questions on platforms like IndiaBix and PrepInsta about a month before placements begin. For coding, LeetCode and GeeksforGeeks should be sufficient, but it's best to start learning DSA at least three months in advance, as online tests are becoming increasingly challenging.

Round 2: Technical Interview 1

In this round, the interviewer was friendly and helped me feel at ease, knowing it was my first interview. He started with a real-life problem that required sorting as a solution. I explained Merge Sort in detail, as it's a good algorithm for in-depth discussion. He asked a few follow-up questions as well.

We then discussed the differences between C++ and Java, and the interviewer dug deeper into this topic. Next, he moved on to system design and posed the problem statement: *"Consider you're storing data about all Indians in a database. How would you design such a database? What factors would you consider?"* I suggested a few solutions to improve access time, reduce latency, and enhance scalability.

I felt I didn't do well on the system design part, but the interviewer gave a positive response.

Round 3: Technical Interview 2

This round began with a basic question: *"What is your favorite data structure?"* I chose graphs and explained traversal algorithms. The

interviewer asked several real-life questions, and I answered them using concepts like cycle detection, shortest path, and weighted graphs.

The conversation then shifted to my projects. I walked him through the entire process, and he asked about alternatives to the stack I used and the innovations I implemented. We also covered some HR questions, like where I see myself in 3-5 years, handling conflicts within a team, and task assignments.

Overall, this round went smoothly. The interviewer seemed pleased, and his feedback was positive.

Tip:

To succeed in technical interviews, it's important to clearly explain your ideas and solutions. Don't let anxiety or nerves get the best of you; mock interviews can help build confidence. Be thoroughly familiar with everything on your resume, as most questions will be asked from it.

Round 4: Behavioral + HR Round

This round was more like a conversation than a formal interview. I was expecting the usual HR questions, but the interviewer seemed genuinely interested in getting to know me. She asked about my passions and how my college experience has shaped my character. Since she was also involved in the pre-placement talk, I asked her a few questions based on that, and she seemed impressed with my attentiveness.

The HR round lasted about 20 minutes and ended on a positive note. In total, 20 students were selected.

Key topics to focus on include:

- DSA (for Online Assessments and Interviews)
- Aptitude
- Core Subjects
- Projects
- System Design
- Puzzles

Don't hesitate to get in touch if any support is needed ! ALL THE BEST !

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